

Unwind

The year that went by had a lot of highs and lows and there were some movies that just didn't cut it

Community

Hear what a digit reader has to say about Mobile home screens and an avid AMD fanboy's rant

When Technology Goes #Fail

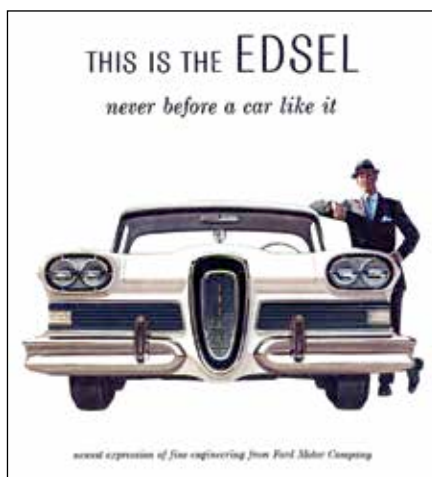
13 EPIC Tech Fails Till 2013

Samir Alam

readersletters@thinkdigit.com

1 Cinerama Technology (1952 to Now)

Now could have been something seriously cool. The Cinerama experience was the first IMAX-killer projection technology that was actually invented decades before the IMAX! Covering a widescreen expanse of 146 degrees in its vision, images were breath taking, immersive and holy hell complicated to shoot. Faced with the many challenges - from shooting and editing footage to eventually projecting it on screen - the Cinerama system demanded three projectionists to work in near Borg like collective harmony. Developed decades before computerization and automa-



company in partnership with Motorola planned to connect 66 satellites in orbit so anyone, anywhere could call anyone, anywhere else with just one phone. Of course this was all in the early-90s when cellphones were still finding their footing and anything was possible in the haze of pre-bubble Silicone Valley dreams. Unfortunately, not everyone could be in line of sight with a satellite (car, tunnel, home, name it) or for that matter afford the USD \$3000 price tag that came with the handset. The company that became operational in 1993 met its quiet end in 1999. I expect you to die Mr. Bond.



2 Ford Edsel (1957)

The bigger they are the harder they fall. Such was the case with Ford's Edsel, a product born from the ego of Mr. Edsel Ford, President of the Ford Motor Company in 1957. Yes ladies and gentlemen, he named it after himself! And it lived up to the name. An over-hyped, egocentric, pricy and inefficient car that has been held up over the decades as a prime example of "marketing failure" and "design failure" wrapped up in one ugly looking package. The wrong product, at the wrong time, for the wrong reasons. Enough said.



tion of digital film, Cinerama was ahead of its time and is extremely difficult to be adapted in the mainstream today. There are still a few theatres in America and UK that use it. Try it out if you get the chance.

3 Motorola Iridium (1993)

Its hard to hide the disappointment over the failure of Iridium. Almost like a scheme out of a James Bond villain's handbook, the global satellite phone

4 Apple MessagePad/Newton (1993)

In crowded hallways of Apple headquarters and Macworld Expos there still scurries a breed of geek nursing the Apple